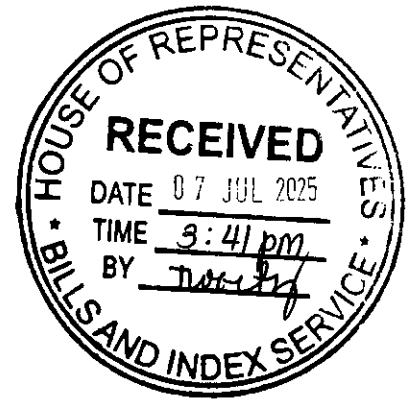




Republic of the Philippines
HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
Quezon City

TWENTIETH CONGRESS
First Regular Session



HOUSE BILL NO. 1484

Introduced by Representative **ANTONINO B. ROMAN III**

EXPLANATORY NOTE

Government services work best when decisions are based on facts and data. Today, we have new tools like artificial intelligence (AI) and data analysis that can help government agencies plan better, respond faster, and serve the people more efficiently.

This bill—called the Data-Driven Governance and AI Solutions Act—aims to support government agencies in using technology to improve how they work. It encourages partnerships between government, universities, and private tech companies to come up with new and smarter ways to deliver public services. For example, AI can help:

- Predict where floods are likely to happen so communities can prepare ahead of time.
- Improve traffic flow by analyzing real-time road data.
- Detect fraud in public funds or tax collections.
- Make it easier for citizens to get information or help from government offices using chatbots or online systems.

The bill proposes the creation of a fund to support pilot projects in local governments and national agencies. These projects will be developed by teams made up of government offices, state universities, and private tech companies.

To make sure these projects are done responsibly, the bill also requires them to follow privacy laws and ethical guidelines, especially when using personal or sensitive data.

Lastly, the bill provides for training programs to help government workers understand how to use data and technology in their work.

While the Philippine Innovation Act (RA 11293) lays down the strategic framework for promoting innovation across all sectors, this bill focuses specifically on enabling innovation within government operations. It serves as a targeted program that translates national innovation goals into practical, data and AI-driven solutions for better governance. This bill complements RA 11293 by empowering public agencies and local government units to apply advanced digital tools in day-to-day service delivery, policy design, and resource allocation—areas that require a more focused and operational approach outside the broad ambit of the Innovation Council's mandate.

By using modern tools and working closely with experts and local innovators, this bill can help government make smarter decisions, serve the public better, and solve problems faster.

Given the government's limited resources, this bill proposes an initial appropriation of ₱250 million to support a select number of AI-driven pilot projects and training programs. It encourages the use of existing public infrastructure, cost-sharing with LGUs, and co-funding by the private sector and development partners. This frugal and phased approach ensures that government spending remains prudent while still fostering innovation.

For these reasons, passage of this bill is respectfully recommended.



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AN ACT
PROMOTING DATA-DRIVEN GOVERNANCE AND ARTIFICIAL
INTELLIGENCE SOLUTIONS IN THE PUBLIC SECTOR THROUGH
GOVERNMENT-INDUSTRY-ACADEMIA COLLABORATION, AND
APPROPRIATING FUNDS THEREFOR

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress assembled:

SECTION 1. Short Title. -- This Act shall be known as the “Data-Driven Governance and AI Solutions Act.”

SECTION 2. Declaration of Policy. -- It is the policy of the State to use technology and data to help government work smarter, faster, and more efficiently for the people. In line with Republic Act No. 11293, or the Philippine Innovation Act, this law supports efforts to improve government services through partnerships with schools, experts, and tech companies. By using tools like artificial intelligence and data analysis, the government can plan better, respond quicker, and deliver services that truly meet the needs of Filipinos.

SECTION 3. Objectives. -- This Act seeks to:

1. Enable the national and local governments to adopt AI and data-driven systems for public planning, service delivery, and decision-making;
2. Institutionalize multi-sectoral pilot projects between public agencies, universities, and private technology partners;
3. Create a legal and funding framework for AI-enabled public innovation; and
4. Build local talent in AI, data science, and digital governance.

SECTION 4. Creation of the AI Governance Innovation Fund. -- There is hereby created the AI Governance Innovation Fund (AGIF) under the Department of Science and Technology (DOST), with an initial appropriation of ₱250 million, to be used exclusively for:

1. Funding pilot projects by consortia of government agencies, Higher Educational Institutions (HEIs), and technology firms;
2. Establishing regional AI Governance Hubs in at least four regions;
3. Capacity-building for government employees and data officers; and
4. Research on ethical and inclusive AI governance.

SECTION 5. Eligible Projects. -- Eligible pilot projects under this Act include, but are not limited to:

1. Traffic flow optimization using AI prediction models;
2. Disaster risk mapping and early warning systems;
3. Predictive analytics for education, health, and social services;
4. Digital twins for infrastructure and climate resilience;
5. Chatbots or virtual assistants for frontline services;
6. Fraud detection in tax collection or procurement; and
7. Natural language processing for document management.

SECTION 6. Composition of Project Consortia. -- Each AI governance project funded under this Act must be undertaken by a consortium composed of:

1. A lead government agency or Local Government Unit;
2. At least one state university or college (SUC) or recognized Research, Development, and Innovation (RDI) institution; and
3. At least one private tech company or startup.

SECTION 7. National AI Governance Steering Committee. -- A National AI Governance Steering Committee (NAIGSC) is hereby created under the DOST to oversee the implementation of this Act. It shall be composed of:

1. Secretary of DOST, as Chairperson;
2. Secretary of the Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT);
3. Executive Director of the National Innovation Council;

4. Chairperson of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED);
5. Representative from the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG);
6. Two private sector representatives (AI industry and civil society);
7. One representative from SUCs, as recommended by PASUC.

The Committee shall:

1. Approve project grants;
2. Issue ethical and technical guidelines;
3. Monitor performance and impact; and
4. Recommend scaling and replication of successful pilots.

SECTION 8. Capacity-Building. -- The DOST and the Development Academy of the Philippines (DAP), in coordination with DICT, shall develop and implement training programs for public officials and civil servants in the following areas:

1. Data governance and data privacy;
2. AI ethics and accountability;
3. AI procurement and vendor evaluation; and
4. Agile project management and policy experimentation.

SECTION 9. Safeguards and Responsible Use. -- All projects under this Act must:

1. Comply with the Data Privacy Act of 2012;
2. Undergo an AI Ethics Impact Assessment as prescribed by the Steering Committee;
3. Ensure explainability, fairness, and non-discrimination in algorithm design; and
4. Publish non-sensitive results and evaluations for public transparency.

SECTION 10. Appropriations. -- The initial amount of ₱250 million shall be appropriated from the current year's General Appropriations Act under the Department of Science and Technology (DOST). This amount shall fund a limited number of pilot projects, capacity-building programs, and the establishment of AI Governance Hubs using existing government infrastructure where feasible. Thereafter, such sums as may be necessary for the continued implementation of this Act shall be included in the annual General Appropriations Act, subject to the performance and impact of initial projects. To further support the program, the Fund may also accept grants, donations, or co-financing from international development partners, private sector collaborators, and local government units.

SECTION 11. Implementing Rules and Regulations. -- Within ninety (90) days from the effectivity of this Act, the DOST, in consultation with the DICT, CHED, DILG, and other relevant agencies and stakeholders, shall promulgate the implementing rules and regulations of this Act.

SECTION 12. Separability Clause. -- If any provision of this Act is declared unconstitutional, the remaining provisions shall remain in full force and effect.

SECTION 13. Repealing Clause. -- All laws, orders, rules, and regulations inconsistent with this Act are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

This Act shall be implemented in a manner consistent with Republic Act No. 11293, otherwise known as the "Philippine Innovation Act." It operationalizes the objectives of RA 11293 by focusing on the use of artificial intelligence (AI), data analytics, and digital tools in the public sector, particularly in the areas of governance, service delivery, and policy decision-making. Nothing in this Act shall be construed as superseding or duplicating the functions of the National Innovation Council; instead, it shall support and complement the Council's strategies by enabling sector-specific innovations in government institutions and local government units.

SECTION 14. Effectivity. -- This Act shall take effect fifteen (15) days after its publication in the Official Gazette or in a newspaper of general circulation.

Approved,